



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tempe Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://www.tempeprep.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School**

School website audited: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Why: Austin Classical School explicitly anchors its mission in Christ and in the cultivation of wisdom and virtue; it foregrounds Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; it structures curriculum around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), includes Latin, logic, and rhetoric, and employs Socratic discussion, memorization/recitation, and imitation. Its philosophy and language align closely with the Six Essential Elements positive keyword indicators across Religious Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, and Pedagogy. Faculty and Parents/Community evidence is positive but thinner in explicit classical phrasing, so those two categories score "Somewhat Classical." - Most salient evidence from the site: - "exists to glorify Jesus Christ ... cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students ... classical, Christian education" - "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty: Classical Education Basics ... cultivate wisdom and virtue ... contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful ... great books ... great conversation ... the Trivium" - Trivium stages with memorization, recitation, songs; logic via debate/discussion; rhetoric via thesis defense and eloquent speech; Latin beginning in 5th; logic and rhetoric in upper grades - "less about training for a specific, temporal vocation ... learning to think and live with an eternal purpose" (formation over workforce prep) - "We employ the Socratic method" and explicit Trivium-based pedagogy; "Bible ... at the center of the great conversation about the true, the good, and the beautiful ... we study those great books"

Method note: The audit follows the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword framework—positive and negative indicators for each category—and the supporting lexicon used by this GPT. These served as the scoring backbone for all six categories, as instructed.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations 1) Keywords found on the site (examples; exact matches in quotes): - Transcendentals, virtue/formation: "True, ... Good, ... Beautiful," "wisdom," "virtue," "cultivate ... wise, virtuous ... students" - Grounded in theology: "glorify Jesus Christ," "Bible ... at the center," "Scripture ... God's holy, inerrant, and infallible Word" - Contemplation/wonder: "contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful" - Liturgical/worship terms: no explicit "chapel," "liturgy," or "hymnody" found in the crawl 2) Comparison to Six Elements positive/negative lists: - Strong positive matches to truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom/virtue; sacred scripture; faith and reason; Christian formation (positive indicators). - No negative signals (e.g., "values-neutral," "subjective truth") were observed. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits: 12 - Negative keyword hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage estimate: 0.80 (robust on transcendental moral realism and theology; minimal explicit liturgical practice language) - Pos/Neg: +12/-0 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal 1) Keywords found: - Aim of education: "cultivate wisdom and virtue," "truth, goodness, and beauty," "less about ... vocation ... eternal purpose" (formation > information/workforce) 2) Comparison: - Matches Six Elements positives: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty; formation rather than information. - Explicit denial of "job-first" aims; no "college and career ready/21st century skills" marketing (negative signals) present. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 12 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: 0.95 - Pos/Neg: +12/-0 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: Curriculum 1) Keywords found: - Liberal arts/Trivium: "Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric ... the Trivium" - Classical languages: "students begin taking Latin in 5th ... continue ... logic ... rhetoric" - Great

Books/Great Conversation: “great ideas,” “great books,” “great conversation,” “Bible at the center ... of the great conversation” - Integration/history: “interrelation of all knowledge ... literature relates to history ... art and music ... under the sovereignty of God through theology” (interdisciplinary/integrated) - Senior Thesis noted (capstone rhetoric) - “History” used; no “social studies” emphasis detected 2) Comparison: - Direct alignment with Trivium/Quadrivium language, Great Books, integration, wonder; no STEM-first or project-based dominance (negative signals). 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 14 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: 0.90 - Pos/Neg: +14/-0 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods 1) Keywords found: - Lower school memory work: “memorization, recitation, and songs” - Socratic/discussion: “learn best through debate and discussion,” “We employ the Socratic method” - Rhetoric practice: “thesis defense ... eloquent ... written and oral communication,” imitation of models in rhetoric - Restful/Scholé/Contemplation: explicit “contemplation” in TGB statement; no explicit “scholé” term found 2) Comparison: - Strong matches to positive pedagogy: memory/chanting, Socratic/dialectic, rhetoric/orations, contemplation; no project-based-only or constructivist emphasis (negatives). 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 10 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: 0.85 (no explicit “scholé” term, though contemplation is present) - Pos/Neg: +10/-0 4) Rating: CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty 1) Keywords found: - Vocation/ethos: “our job as educators is to be faithful stewards ... hopefulness” (virtue/formation implied) - Explicit classical “teachers as mentors, living curriculum, collegiality, portrait of a teacher”: not clearly articulated in available crawl 2) Comparison: - Some alignment with “teachers as models of virtue” (stewardship/virtue language), but limited explicit faculty-formation/mentorship terminology compared to Six Elements positives. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 3 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: 0.40 (faculty portrait/mentorship phrasing largely missing in crawl sample) - Pos/Neg: +3/-0 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents and Community 1) Keywords found: - Parent partnership: “co-laboring with families” (mission) - Hospitality/access: campus “tours,” “prospective parent meeting” page (welcoming parents on campus) - Parent formation: public “Recommended Reading” to understand classical education (supports parent learning) - Ongoing explicit “parent book clubs/covenant/open campus any time”: not found in crawl 2) Comparison: - Clear parent partnership and some parent-education cues; less explicit ongoing parent-formation programming than many classical schools advertise. 3) Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: 5 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Coverage: 0.60 - Pos/Neg: +5/-0 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating - Four categories rated CLASSICAL (1–4) with strong positive lexicon alignment and zero negative hits. - Two categories rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (5–6) due to limited explicitness in faculty portrait/mentorship language and less formalized parent-formation programming in the crawl sample. - Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Notes on the keyword framework used - Positive/negative indicators for each category were drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword lists, which emphasize transcendental moral realism; theological grounding; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; teachers as mentors; and parent partnership/formation. The school’s language repeatedly matches the positive sets and avoids the negative sets such as “values-neutral,” “career readiness,” “21st-century skills,” “project-based” dominance, etc.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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